

The cast

THE VICTIM

Augustus “Gus” Whitlock, owner of the Blue Lantern Club in Gull Harbor. Generous host, keen art collector, and fond of a grand announcement. He promised the whole room news “that will change everything” at midnight.

Remy Quill

THE ART DEALER
CORE

You know what everything in this room is worth. Tonight, that includes a secret. Owner of Quill Fine Art on Harbor Street. Sold Gus the three Elias Thorne seascapes that hang in the club gallery.

Suit style: A charcoal three-piece suit, a peacock-blue silk tie, white evening gloves and a peacock-feather lapel pin. **Dress style:** A peacock-blue beaded dress, long white evening gloves and a peacock-feather pin or hair clip.

Avery Lark

THE RESIDENT SINGER
CORE

Every night at the Blue Lantern ends with your song. Tonight, someone wrote a different ending. The voice of the Blue Lantern for six years. Gus has just told Avery that the contract ends this month.

Suit style: A midnight-blue tuxedo with satin lapels, a silver bow tie and a sparkly lapel pin. **Dress style:** A sequined drop-waist dress, a long string of pearls and a feathered headband.

Jordan Pierce

THE CLUB PARTNER
CORE

Twelve years of hard work, and Gus wanted to sell it all at midnight. Gus’s partner in the Blue Lantern for twelve years. Runs the club day to day.

Suit style: A black dinner jacket, a gold waistcoat, a pocket watch and slicked-back hair. **Dress style:** A gold fringe dress, a black velvet wrap and a pocket watch on a long chain.

Sidney Hart

GUS’S WARD AND HEIR
CORE

The Blue Lantern is the only home you have ever known. Raised by Gus since the age of ten. Studies botany at the college across the bay, and is named in Gus’s will.

Suit style: A tweed jacket, a cream sweater vest, a bow tie and a flower in the buttonhole. **Dress style:** A pale green tea dress, a cardigan, round spectacles and a lily corsage.

Morgan Bellamy

OWNER OF THE GILDED OWL
CORE

Your oldest rival is gone. Funny how nobody looks at you kindly. Owns The Gilded Owl, the rival supper club across the harbour. Has competed with Gus for every band and singer for ten years.

Suit style: A white dinner jacket, a black bow tie and a gold star pin. **Dress style:** A black-and-gold beaded gown, long gloves and a star hair clip.

The cast, continued

Frankie Dade

THE BANDLEADER
CORE

The band plays on, whatever happens. Even in the dark. Leads the eight-piece Blue Lantern Orchestra. Owes Gus a large sum of money.

Suit style: A pinstripe suit, two-tone shoes, a skinny tie and a conductor's baton. **Dress style:** A dark velvet dress, a pinstripe jacket over the shoulders and a conductor's baton.

Charlie Ashby

THE SOCIETY COLUMNIST
CORE

Everyone knows the silver fox. That is exactly the problem. Writes "Harbor Lights", the society column in the Gull Harbor Gazette. Told the whole town in print that Charlie would come as a silver fox.

Suit style: A grey suit, a fedora with a press card in the band, and a notebook. **Dress style:** A grey drop-waist dress, a cloche hat, a press card and a notebook.

Dana Rook

THE CATERER
CORE

Sixty coupes, one tower and one glass that mattered. Owner of Rook Catering, which supplies the club's food and drink. Built tonight's champagne tower of sixty coupes.

Suit style: A white waiter's jacket, black trousers, a bow tie and a silver tray. **Dress style:** A black dress, a white apron, a bow at the collar and a silver tray.

Leslie Croft

GUS'S LAWYER
OPTIONAL

You know what is in the will. Everyone wants to know what you know. Gus's lawyer for twenty years. Drew up the papers for the club sale and knows what is in the will.

Suit style: A dark three-piece suit, wire spectacles and a leather briefcase. **Dress style:** A tailored skirt suit, a high-collared blouse, wire spectacles and a briefcase.

Billie Sable

THE COAT-CHECK
ATTENDANT
OPTIONAL

Every coat, every mask, every face. You saw them all. Runs the coat-check counter and the mask rail in the lobby. Sees every guest come and go.

Suit style: A burgundy bellhop-style jacket with brass buttons and a pillbox cap. **Dress style:** A burgundy uniform dress with brass buttons and a pillbox cap.

Robin Vale

THE AVIATOR
OPTIONAL

You have flown across oceans. Tonight you cannot get out of one room. The aviator who flew the first air-mail route out of Gull Harbor. Lost money in Gus's air-mail company.

Suit style: A leather flying jacket over evening wear, a silk scarf and goggles on your head. **Dress style:** A leather flying jacket over a beaded dress, a silk scarf and goggles.

The cast, continued

Jesse Monroe

THE PHOTOGRAPHER
OPTIONAL

One flash, one photograph, and one guest who did not want it taken. Hired to photograph the masquerade. Took a flash picture at the champagne tower at 11:55.

Suit style: A flat cap, braces, rolled shirtsleeves and a camera on a strap.

Dress style: A flat cap, a long cardigan over a simple dress, and a camera on a strap.

Kit Haverford

THE SHIPPING HEIR
OPTIONAL

You said no to Gus once. Some people never forgot it. Heir to the Haverford shipping line. Was once engaged to Gus, and broke it off.

Suit style: A cream linen suit, a silk cravat and a gold signet ring.

Dress style: A cream silk dress, long pearls and a velvet evening wrap.

Taylor Moss

THE STAGE MAGICIAN
OPTIONAL

You can make a coin vanish. Can you make suspicion vanish too? Performs card tricks at the tables. Knows exactly how to make the lights go out.

Suit style: A tailcoat, a top hat, a red silk handkerchief and a deck of cards.

Dress style: A sequined jacket over a black dress, a top hat and a deck of cards.

Emery Fontaine

THE DANCE INSTRUCTOR
OPTIONAL

You taught half the room the Charleston. Where were you at 11:58? Teaches the Charleston at the Blue Lantern every Thursday. Was not on the dance floor when the lights went out.

Suit style: High-waisted trousers, braces, a crisp shirt and polished dancing shoes.

Dress style: A fringe dress made for the Charleston, a beaded headband and T-strap shoes.

Marion Kettle

THE CLUB CHEF
OPTIONAL

The kitchen sees everything, and the greenhouse key hangs on your wall. Runs the Blue Lantern kitchen. The greenhouse key hangs on a hook by the stove.

Suit style: Chef's whites, a tall toque and a tea towel over one shoulder.

Dress style: A white chef's jacket over a dark skirt, a neat headscarf and a wooden spoon.

Inspector Sloane Whitaker

THE HOST

Came for the music. Stayed to solve a murder. A Gull Harbor police inspector who happened to be at the party in a borrowed mask.

Suit style: A trench coat, a fedora and a pocket notebook.

Dress style: A long belted coat, a cloche hat and a magnifying glass.

CORE AND OPTIONAL

The 8 core characters are always played. Optional characters are added in order as your guest list grows. Every role works for anyone: names are gender-neutral and every character has a suit style and a dress style.